

Italian Musical Terms

Copywork for Young Musicians

Acacia Academy of Music

1. Dynamics — *Soft and loud*

p = piano = soft

f = forte = loud

2. Dynamics — *Medium and very*

mezzo = medium

-issimo = very

3. Dynamics — *Medium soft*

mp = mezzo piano

mp = medium soft

4. Dynamics — *Medium loud*

mf = mezzo forte

mf = medium loud

5. Dynamics — *Very soft*

pp = pianissimo

pp = very soft

6. Dynamics — *Very loud*

ff = fortissimo

ff = very loud

7. Dynamics — *Gradually louder*

crescendo = cresc.

cresc. = gradually louder

8. Dynamics — *Gradually softer*

decrescendo = decresc.

decresc. = gradually softer

9. Dynamics — *Gradually softer*

diminuendo = dim.

dim. = gradually softer

10. Tempo - Speed — *Quick and fairly quick*

Allegro = quick

Allegretto = fairly quick

11. Tempo - Speed — *Moderately and walking pace*

Moderato = moderately

Andante = walking pace

12. Tempo - Speed — *Slow and original speed*

Adagio = slow

A tempo = original speed

13. Tempo - Speed — *Gradually faster*

accelerando = accel.

accel. = gradually faster

14. Tempo - Speed — *Gradually slower*

rallentando = rall.

rall. = gradually slower

15. Tempo - Speed — *Gradually slower*

ritardando = rit.

rit. = gradually slower

16. Italian Terms — *Character and style*

cantabile = singing style

dolce = sweetly

da capo = D.C.

D.C. = from the start

18. Italian Terms — *Musical instructions*

fine = the end

al fine = up to the end

19. Articulation — *Smooth and detached*

legato = smoothly

staccato = detached